

RetailzPOS — AEO/GEO Improvement Strategy

Prepared: July 30, 2026 **Scope:** A prioritized, tactical action plan to move the scores from `retailzpos-ai-visibility-audit-2026-07.md` — targeting the exact gaps that audit found, not a generic SEO checklist.

0. Starting point

Engine	Score	The one-line reason
Microsoft Copilot (Bing)	48/100	Strong on Gartner Digital Markets properties (SoftwareAdvice, GetApp, Slashdot, Capterra) that Bing indexes heavily
ChatGPT (Search)	45/100	Accurate on branded/comparison queries; loses to established listicle domains on category queries
Perplexity	42/100	Citation-dense engine; zero Reddit/Quora presence hurts it more than the others
Google AI Overviews/ Gemini	38/100	Content is crawled and indexed but isn't earning enough backlink authority to be cited

The single diagnosis every recommendation below traces back to: RetailzPOS is accurately known when asked about *by name*, and invisible when asked a generic category question — for liquor POS, smoke shop POS, and age verification/compliance specifically. That's a citation/authority gap, not a content gap. Everything in this plan exists to close that specific gap, not to write more content for its own sake.

1. Priority framework

Three tiers, ranked by how directly each moves the specific failed queries from the audit, not by general SEO best-practice importance:

- **Tier 1 (do first):** Citation and authority building — backlinks and genuine community presence. This is the actual bottleneck per the audit's own evidence (content exists, citations don't).
 - **Tier 2 (structural):** AEO content restructuring and technical schema on the specific pages tested in the audit.
 - **Tier 3 (compounding):** Review growth and ongoing measurement — slower-moving but cheap and durable.
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2. Tier 1a — Close the citation/authority gap

This is the highest-leverage fix available, and it's already designed: `retailzpos-guest-posting-backlink-strategy-2026-07.md` and the KORONA competitive deep-dive (`korona-pos-competitive-content-seo-deep-`

dive-2026-07.md) both exist for exactly this. Two things to change about how it's executed, specifically because of what the audit found:

1. **Link to the specific pages that failed, not the homepage.** The audit found RetailzPOS's own `liquor-store-pos-systems-2026` and `best-liquor-store-pos-systems` posts are crawled and indexed but not cited. When placing guest-post links or trade-press mentions, point contextual anchor text directly at those specific URLs (e.g., "a full breakdown of liquor store POS options" linking to the comparison page) — not a generic homepage link. Page-specific authority is what's missing, and generic homepage links don't transfer it efficiently.
2. **This is a moderate-competition query set, not a head-term fight.** "Best POS system for liquor stores" and "POS for smoke shops" aren't "best CRM software" — the field of real competitors is small (Square, KORONA, Bottle POS, NRS, Lightspeed, a handful of others). A realistic, evidence-grounded target: even 5-10 quality contextual backlinks to the two failed comparison pages, from the Tier 1 sources already identified (Retail Dive's Submit an Opinion program, Retail TouchPoints Executive ViewPoints), is plausibly enough to shift Google's and ChatGPT's citation behavior on these specific queries within a quarter — this is a directional estimate based on the query difficulty observed, not a guaranteed outcome.

Do this specifically for the compliance/age-verification query too. The compliance-authority guide and the PACT Act/SHAFT/TCPA blog post are strong content that isn't yet earning citations either — apply the same page-specific link-building to those, not just the liquor-store comparison pages.

3. Tier 1b — Execute the Reddit/Quora strategy that's sitting at zero

The audit found literally zero Reddit and Quora presence. `retailzpos-aeo-geo-reddit-quora-strategy-2026-07.md` was built for this and hasn't produced visible results yet. This is worth prioritizing above almost anything else structural, because of how these specific engines behave:

- **Perplexity leans on Reddit and Quora more heavily than any of the other three** for "best of" and recommendation-style answers — it's the most citation-dense engine tested, and community threads are exactly the citation type it favors.
- **ChatGPT increasingly cites Reddit threads as a credibility signal** for B2B software recommendation queries specifically (distinct from how it treats general informational queries).

Execution discipline that matters here, learned earlier in this project from the r/POS research: genuine, non-promotional participation has to come first. Answer real questions in the identified subreddits for a period before the brand name ever appears in a post — a first appearance that reads as a drive-by plug gets ignored or removed, and burns the account's credibility in a small community faster than it builds anything. Treat this as a multi-week trust-building motion, not a one-time post.

4. Tier 2a — Win the 3 specific failed queries with AEO-formatted content

For each of the three queries the audit confirmed RetailzPOS loses — "best POS for liquor stores," "POS for smoke shops," "age verification/compliance POS" — restructure the existing target page (not new content, the pages already exist) with:

1. **A direct-answer block in the first 2-3 sentences of the page**, phrased to directly answer the query itself, naming RetailzPOS specifically. AI engines preferentially extract the first clearly-scoped answer on a page rather than synthesizing one from scattered content further down.
2. **The comparison table moved higher on the page**, not buried after several paragraphs of narrative setup — scannable, structured comparison data is what these engines extract most cleanly for "best of" queries.
3. **FAQPage schema with 5-8 questions phrased the way a real buyer would type them** — "What is the best POS system for a liquor store?", "Does RetailzPOS support age verification at checkout?", "How much does RetailzPOS cost?" Pages with FAQPage markup are measurably more likely to be cited in AI-generated answers specifically on Perplexity, ChatGPT, and Bing/Copilot. [Source: [SEOScore.tools](#), [FAQ Schema Markup 2026](#), [Frase](#), [Are FAQ Schemas Important for AI Search](#)]

An important, current caveat that directly explains why Google scored lowest in the audit: Google removed FAQ rich results from its own Search results in May 2026 — FAQPage schema still retains full value for Perplexity, Bing/Copilot, and ChatGPT, but it no longer produces a rich-result citation boost specifically on Google. For Google AI Overviews specifically, roughly 76% of citations come from pages that are already ranking in the top 10 organic results — meaning **backlink authority (Tier 1 above) is the dominant lever for Google specifically, not schema**. [Source: [StackMatix](#), [Optimizing FAQ Schema for Google AI Overviews 2026](#)] This is exactly consistent with what the audit found — Google's the one where content is indexed but uncited, and that's a ranking-authority problem, not a content-formatting problem.

5. Tier 2b — Technical schema implementation

The audit couldn't verify retailzpos.com's technical GEO signals directly (site fetch blocked). Turn that unknown into a known, executed baseline:

Organization schema — implement with `sameAs` links to every verified real profile the audit confirmed: the Capterra listing, GetApp, SourceForge, Slashdot, SoftwareAdvice, Trustpilot, and the Birdeye review page. This is what lets an AI system's knowledge graph confirm RetailzPOS is a real, cross-referenced entity rather than an ambiguous or unverified name — directly useful for every one of the four engines.

SoftwareApplication/Product schema with AggregateRating — pull the real Birdeye figure (30 reviews, 4.5 stars) confirmed in the audit into structured data on the site itself. Use the real, current number only — never a placeholder, and update it as the review count changes (see Tier 3).

FAQPage schema — on the three target pages from Section 4, as described above.

Validate before publishing — run every schema block through Google's Rich Results Test and the Schema.org validator before it goes live; malformed schema is worse than none, since it can cause a crawler to distrust the rest of the page's markup.

On llms.txt — a low-priority, optional addition, not a fix. This is a real, emerging community convention (a plain-text file describing a site's content for AI crawlers), but current 2026 adoption data puts it at roughly 10-15% of tech/documentation sites, and actual AI-crawler traffic hitting the file directly is around 0.1% of total crawler traffic — no major LLM crawls it on a production schedule yet. [Source: [aeo.press](#), [The State of llms.txt in 2026](#), [LinkBuildingHQ](#), [Should Websites Implement llms.txt in 2026?](#)] Cheap to add once the schema work above is done, but don't expect it to move any of the four scores meaningfully on its own — it's a "nice to have," not a lever.

6. Engine-specific tactical notes

Since the four engines don't weight the same signals identically, here's what matters most per engine, mapped back to the tiers above:

- **Microsoft Copilot (Bing) — grow reviews specifically on the Gartner Digital Markets properties.** SoftwareAdvice, GetApp, and Capterra are all Gartner-owned and heavily indexed by Bing. A direct post-sale ask for reviews on these three platforms specifically (not just Birdeye) is the single most targeted lever for this engine.
 - **Perplexity — Reddit/Quora execution (Tier 1b) is the highest-leverage single action.** This is the most citation-hungry engine of the four and the one most directly held back by the zero-community-presence finding.
 - **ChatGPT — the comparison-page work (Tier 1a) matters most.** It already handles branded/comparison queries well; the gap is category-listicle authority, which is exactly what page-specific backlinks fix.
 - **Google AI Overviews/Gemini — backlink/E-E-A-T authority (Tier 1a) is the dominant lever, full stop.** Per Section 4's caveat, schema and on-page formatting help less here than on the other three engines specifically because of how Google's AI Overview sourcing works. This is also the lowest-scoring engine, so it has the most room to move.
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7. Tier 3 — Grow the review base

RetailzPOS's 30 reviews / 4.5 stars on Birdeye is a real, confirmed asset — and review count and freshness are trust signals all four engines lean on. Put a systematic post-sale review request into the actual customer workflow (not a one-time push), spread across Birdeye, Capterra, G2, and Trustpilot specifically — those are the platforms confirmed to already carry RetailzPOS listings and the ones Section 6 identifies as mattering most per engine.

8. Measurement plan

The audit's Section 1 queries are now a repeatable benchmark, not a one-time test. Re-run the exact same five searches — "best POS system for liquor stores," "POS for smoke shops," "age verification POS compliance," "RetailzPOS reddit," "RetailzPOS quora" — monthly, and log whether RetailzPOS starts appearing in the

synthesized answer, not just the raw link list. **A reasonable, non-guaranteed 90-day target: RetailzPOS named in at least one of the three previously-failed unbranded queries.** That's a directional goal to organize the work around, not a promised outcome — GEO citation behavior isn't fully controllable, but it is measurable, and re-running the same test is how you'll actually know if the tiered work above is working.

9. 90-day roadmap

Phase	Weeks	Focus
1	1-4	Implement Organization/Product/FAQPage schema (Section 5); begin genuine, non-promotional Reddit/Quora participation (Section 3); start guest-post outreach to Tier 1 targets with page-specific anchor links (Section 2)
2	5-8	Restructure the three target pages with direct-answer blocks and elevated comparison tables (Section 4); launch the systematic review-request workflow (Section 7); first guest posts likely publish
3	9-12	Re-run the audit's benchmark queries (Section 8); evaluate what moved and what didn't; double down on whichever tier shows the clearest signal rather than spreading effort evenly

10. Sources

- [SEOScore.tools](#) — FAQ Schema Markup 2026: Get Cited by ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI
- [Frase](#) — Are FAQ Schemas Important for AI Search, GEO & AEO?
- [StackMatix](#) — Optimizing FAQ Schema for Google AI Overviews (2026)
- [aeo.press](#) — The State of llms.txt in 2026
- [LinkBuildingHQ](#) — Should Websites Implement llms.txt in 2026?
- Internal: `retailzpos-ai-visibility-audit-2026-07.md`, `retailzpos-guest-posting-backlink-strategy-2026-07.md`, `retailzpos-aeo-geo-reddit-quora-strategy-2026-07.md`, `korona-pos-competitive-content-seo-deep-dive-2026-07.md`, `retailzpos-content-seo-backlink-hybrid-strategy-2026-07.md`

Schema and query-phrasing recommendations reflect 2026 platform behavior as of the sources above — verify current schema support directly with Google's Rich Results Test before publishing, since AI platform behavior around structured data continues to change.